Economics 3347: International Trade
Fall Semester 2017
CSI 337

Professor: G.C. Pieters

Office Hours: Tuesday & Thursday: 3:30-5:00pm
Friday: 12:00-4:00pm

Emails will be returned within 24 hrs EXCEPT: (a) weekends, (b) answer is on TLearn's forum, (c) answer is in the syllabus or (d) answer is on the exam information sheet. In addition to being available during office hours, I am also available right after class and by appointment. During the writing of your drafts, I expect **you** to schedule an appointment with me to review feedback you received, technical problems you may be experiencing, or any skill shortfalls.

Course Description and Objectives:
Econ 3347 studies the economic theory of international trade theory, trade restrictions, and policy, with application of the theory to real-life observations. Practice is provided in reading and understanding published sources of data and analysis. Satisfies Requirements for: Economics (Economics and Business, International concentrations), International Studies, International Business
Prerequisite: ECON 1312 and ECON 3325

Course Announcements and Materials
Important and urgent information on the class will be sent to your university email account. Be sure to check your university email daily for announcements. I will make in class announcements and homework clarifications that do not appear online. Additional course material may be posted on TLearn, it is your responsibility to check for these materials. It is also your responsibility to check that you have access to this course on TLearn before the first homework assignment is due – not having access is not a reason for a homework extension.

Textbook: The best reference book for this course *International Economics: Theory and Policy* by Krugman, Obstfeld and Melitz, 10th edition. We will be unable to cover the book in its entirety, and I will not be following the order of the chapters. I will deviate from the material in the book, including teaching material not in the book. You will be responsible for all material that we cover in lecture and homework. **My lecture notes are NEVER available for your reference.**

Attendance and Participation
"Not attending class is like renting a hotel room then sleeping on the street." - Unknown
The course is designed under the assumption that you are attending all classes – if you miss class, you will miss material on exams or homework, or miss clarifications about homework, which will lower your grade. Full participation during in-class activities, and asking questions when you're confused during class, improves your understanding of the material, which improves your grades on assignments and exams. Given that a lack of attendance and participation has a negative impact on your grade, I do not track or give points for attendance or participation. If you miss class it is your responsibility to get the notes and announcements from a class mate.

Laptops and Cellphones
To encourage participation, cellphones must be turned off (not silent, not vibrate - **OFF**) and laptops put away once class starts.

Office Hours
Office hours are the best way to for me to help you if you have any questions (it's quite difficult to draw a graph in an email!). Bring your class notes for reference. I will not check your homework answers, but I can help you with concepts. The difference is in how you phrase your question…

Disabilities
I have no medical background and cannot determine the appropriate accommodations to provide in the case of disabilities: for this reason all students with disabilities must be registered with Disability Services (dss@trinity.edu) who will work with you and determine what you need. **Please let me know by the second week of class if DSS decides you need accommodation.**

Working with Your Classmates
The homework will contain certain questions that are at a higher level than the problems I have done in class - forming a consistent homework and study group is very beneficial and strongly encouraged. Start one early in the semester!

TLearn Forums
I have a forums set up on TLearn. You should feel free to post AND ANSWER questions on the forums. Everyone will receive an email when something is posted, though you may choose to opt out. No extra credit is given for participating on the forums – beyond the benefit that the response time from your peers may be faster than mine, your class mates may answer questions that I am not willing to answer or answer them in a different (and better) way, and that trying to answer someone's question is a way of testing your own knowledge of the course. I do not mind if people use the forum to post and discuss answers to the homework questions before the assignment is due – though I will not respond and say whether the posted answer is right or wrong.

Academic Dishonesty
Cheating and plagiarism will not be tolerated during exams: I do not care how sorry you are if you are caught cheating, how much your life will be ruined if I report you, if you'll be deported, if you'll be dropped from a sports team, or whether this is the first time you engaged in cheating. Any student who violates the regulations on academic integrity will be subject to the relevant university sanctions (See the Student Handbook for details). Students are required to pledge all written work that is submitted for a grade. **The pledge may be abbreviated "pledged" with a signature.**

Work Load
One credit hour represents a minimum of three hours of student academic work per week for approximately fifteen weeks for one semester, or an equivalent amount of student academic work distributed over a different time period. Student academic work may include lectures, seminars, tutorials, applied and studio instruction, laboratories, supervised fieldwork, as well as reading, writing, homework, research, community-engaged experiences, practica, rehearsals, and performances." (Source: Courses of Study Bulletin**)**

This is a 3 credit hour course: therefore it is expected that you work an **average** of 6 hours outside of the class per week on the course.

Exam
There is one midterm exam, taken in two sections. The first section is **take home** and due on **Thursday, October 5**. The second section is on-class on **Thursday, October 12**. The in-class exam is during normal lecture time. I will NOT provide a review sheet or a written summary of material, definitions, and equations discussed in lecture. The exam is closed book, closed note, with only non-programmable calculators allowed. You may use any resource for the take-home portion of your exam, including discussion with fellow members of the class. You may not use exam material from prior semesters.

Make-up (or early) exams are only available for documented illness or athletic event conflict – having multiple exams is unfortunate, but not a reason for a make-up. In case of car troubles or traffic accident en route to class, bring a dated copy of a mechanic receipt or the accident report. Forgetting, oversleeping, going on vacation, doing poorly or a generic "not feeling well" are not valid reasons to take a make-up exam. Ever.

Any possible grading errors – and despite my best efforts these may occur - must be brought to my attention within 7 days of the return of the exam or homework.

Course Grade Composition

Grading Scale

%	0-59	60-67	68-69	70-71	72-77	78-79	80-81	82-87	88-89	90-91	92-100
Grade	F	D	D+	C-	C	C+	B-	B	B+	A-	A

In order to maintain a C-B average I may implement a curve that lowers the ranges of each letter grade (i.e. change an A- to 88-90 and A to 90-100). I will NEVER raise the minimum % required to achieve a certain letter grade.

What do grades mean anyway?

(Adapted from: http://web.trinity.edu/x10265.xml, "Grades")

A: Superior Understanding of International Trade
B: Good Understanding of International Trade
C: Average Understanding of International Trade
D: Poor Understanding of International Trade
F: (Failure) No Understanding of International Trade
I: "Incomplete" indicates that a student has done work of a passing grade but has failed to do some portion of required work because of an emergency. An I grade may not be given solely to allow additional time to complete a course.
W:"Withdrew from a course". Not used in computing GPA. **November 2** is the last day to withdraw with a "W".

Some of your friends may be able to study for 10 minutes and demonstrate Superior Understanding (an A), while you spend an entire week and receive an F. Grades will NOT be adjusted to reflect the hours you work on the course material, your effort, your class participation, your office hours attendance, your personal worth as a student, your financial aid status, etc. Your grades reflect only your understanding of the material as evaluated by homework and exams.

Grading Plans

	Homework	Midterm	Paper
Standard Grading Plan	25%	25%	50%

I also offer 3 alternative grading plans to all students to accommodate misfortune: I will **automatically** adopt whichever one of these 4 grading options results in the highest grade.

Alternative Grading Plans	Homework	Midterm	Paper
Less weight on Homework	15%	30%	55%
Less weight on Midterm	30%	15%	55%
Less weight on Paper	35%	35%	30%

Each grading category (Homework, Midterm, Paper) is worth 100 points. If you need help determining your grade, there is a grade calculator available on my website (www.ginapieters.com) which will automatically drop your lowest homework score, consider all 4 grading plans, and then present your highest possible grade. TLearn is not capable of this, and calculates your grade under the "Standard Grading Plan" only (so don't panic). I will not calculate your grade for you. **Given these 4 grading plans I do NOT curve midterm or final exams.**

Extra Credit

Despite the 4 grading plans, replacement points, dropping a homework score, and a possible curve, the full spectrum of grades are earned in my class every semester. There will be **NO additional grade assistance** of any sort, under any circumstance. I will ignore all emails that ask for a bonus assignment or a "grade nudge" during or at the end of the semester. Everyone has equal opportunity to earn an A grade (or avoid an F). See the "Homework" and "Exams" section for the re-grade policy in this course. ("Everyone" includes graduating seniors.)

Paper

There will be no extension of deadlines for the due date of the paper, as by the time it is due you will have been turning in a rough draft every week for over a month and the only work that should be left to do is minor corrections and alterations. See the "Paper Assignment" file posted on TLearn and distributed on the first day of class for details.

Presentation

Associated with the paper is an optional presentation for extra credit. If you miss your presentation slot you do not get another opportunity to present. You are allowed to swap presentation time slots with someone else as long as both parties involved notify me by email.

Homework

There are 11 graded assignments worth 10 points each. The lowest scoring assignment will be dropped from your score. Graded (non-draft) homework's of two students will be selected and posted as answer keys - no extra credit will be awarded for this. **Any possible grading errors must be brought to my attention within 7 days of the return of the assignment.**

Group Work on Homework

Cooperation among students on homework is allowed and strongly encouraged. **Submitting a portion or the entirety of another student's homework assignment as your own is NOT group work – it is violation of the honor code. This includes graphs and short answers.**

Submitting your homework

All homework must be submitted online through TLearn. The official deadline is 11:30pm, Thursday. Any assignments that have not been submitted will be automatically finished and submitted at this time. Some questions may ask that you submit files. These files should be in .pdf format and must be less than 5MB. It is your responsibility to make sure that the files open and display your work correctly. I recommend that all files be submitted as .pdf to preserve the formatting.

I grade all submissions of a question (and verify TLearn auto-grading), with student's answers randomized. (So I grade everyone's "4a", then "4b", etc.). Because of this is it very difficult to "refer to answer for the preceding question" or "see graph for previous question". If you find yourself referring to your answer for a prior question, include the graph/picture/etc. again.

Some questions will require math work. You do not need to duplicate this work In TLearn. Instead, take a (clearly visible, correctly oriented, less than 5MB) picture and include this on TLearn as your answer.

Policy on Technical Difficulties

Waiting until the last minute to submit the homework is inevitably when things go wrong. Technical difficulties - which in past semesters have included but are not limited to: obtaining a .pdf of your work, being unable to reduce the file below 5MB, not knowing how to submit assignments to TLearn, forgetting to upload a file, submitting a file that cannot be opened, or going home/on a sports trip and finding you do not have access to the internet/TLearn/pdf conversion - are not reasons for a re-grade or an extension. I cannot and/or will not help you if you have technical difficulties, so do not email me. Google is your friend.

The following will automatically result in zero score for either the assignment or question as appropriate (non-negotiable, no exceptions under ANY condition):

a) You do not turn in the homework through TLearn (for example, you email it to me instead).
b) Attached file is not a .pdf file (and/or another format specifically requested in the assignment).
c) I cannot read your work, or your file cannot open.

Tentative Schedule

This schedule is tentative and will change. In the event that the material changes, the date of exams and homework will **NOT** change, rather the exams and assignments themselves will be altered to reflect what has been covered in class.

Date	Chapters	Lecture Topics	Due
Th: 8/24	3	Measuring Welfare	
Tu: 8/29	1-3	Relative Supply and Demand	
Th: 8/31	6	Trade Supply and Demand	HW1
9/5		*Class Cancelled*	
9/7		*Class Cancelled*	
9/12	3	Ricardian Trade	
9/14	4	Specific Factors Model	HW2
9/19	5	Heckscher Ohlin-Model	
9/21	9	Free Movement of Labor	HW3
9/26	9	Free Movement of Labor	
9/28	7 & 8	Economics of Scale: External	HW4
10/3	7 & 8	Economics of Scale: Internal	
10/5	7 & 8	Monopolistic Competition	**Midterm (Take-Home)**
10/10	1-8	Testing the Theory, Classical vs. New Trade	HW5: Proposal
10/12		**MIDTERM**	**Midterm (In-Class)**
10/17	6,10	Trade Barriers- Classical	
10/19	10	Trade Barriers – Imperfect Competition	HW6
10/24	-	**Draft rewrites**	Draft 1 (in class)
10/26	1	Trade Diversion and Creation	HW7: Draft 1 (rewrite)
10/31	-	Real World Tariff Examples	
11/02	10	Politics of International Agreements	
11/07	10	Import Substitution, Export Led Growth	
11/09	11	Export & Production Subsidies	HW8: Draft 2
11/14	11	Dumping, Non-Traditional Trade Barriers	
11/16	-	Catch-Up/Presentations	HW9: Draft 3
11/21	-	Catch-Up/Presentations	
11/23		*Thanksgiving Holiday*	HW10: Complete Draft
11/28	-	Catch-Up/Presentations	
11/30		Catch-Up/Presentations	HW11
12/05	-	Catch-Up/Presentations	**Paper Due (December 5)**